Alexander Shaham

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EXPERIENCE

Chuken Studios — Independent Game Developer — Feb 2026 – Present

Runefall: classless arena-and-dungeon RPG for PC · Godot 4, C#, .NET 10, Steamworks · playable online

- Designed the **Rune Forge**, the core system that replaces classes by letting players build their own ten-ability kits.
- Built the core combat, including the ability state machine, casts, channels, projectiles, zones, interrupts, and six crowd-control categories with diminishing returns and a hostage guard.
- Built an engine-free, server-authoritative 60 Hz simulation with deterministic replays and vision-filtered snapshots, played online over Steam Datagram Relay with lag compensation and reconnect.
- Built bot AI that uses the same commands as players and sees only its own team's vision. Bots fill short queues, take the role a dungeon party lacks, and run the boss's phases.
- Set the readability rules, including colorblind-safe colors, lightness before hue, and one telegraph style for players and bosses.
- Backed it with 5,000+ xUnit tests, including golden replays verified by state hash and zero-allocation checks on hot paths.
- Prototyped in Unreal Engine 5 (C++, GAS), then moved to Godot 4 and C#. Planned through a GDD and 450+ YouTrack tickets.

HCL BigFix — Frontend Software Engineer (SaaS) — Aug 2023 – Feb 2025

- Built and maintained a React + MUI component library adopted by 100+ engineers in 7+ apps.
- Shipped 100+ versioned, documented components at 95%+ test coverage, plus a Storybook-style workbench where engineering, QA, and design reviewed components together.
- Mentored 4 engineers across teams on onboarding, design-system usage, and architectural standards.

Full-stack Software Engineering Intern (WebUI) — May 2023 – Aug 2023

- Integrated Tenable SC and IO into the security-data ingestion pipeline (Node.js, SQL, REST).

Freelance — Web Developer — 2022 – 2023

- Built an accessible, multilingual landing page for a healthcare clinic in React and JavaScript.

PROJECTS

Guild Golem | TypeScript, React Router, Hono, Cloudflare Workers, D1, R2 — guildgolem.com

- Guild management site for World of Warcraft: Forever, with a raid calendar and Discord sign-ups, raid planner, roster and attendance, loot by council, EPGP, or DKP, and a 13-command Discord bot.
- Rebuilt my earlier Logs and Sims apps inside it, with combat logs parsed in a Web Worker and a sim for 23 specs on game-client data. It has 1,000+ tests and a strict CSP, and bundle budgets are checked before every deploy.

Drafts | TypeScript, React, Hono, Durable Objects, D1, KV, Workers AI — drafts.ajshaham.workers.dev

- Real-time League and Dota 2 draft rooms that suggest picks and bans from matchups and synergies, with an AI draft coach.

Tally | JavaScript, IndexedDB, PWA, Cloudflare Workers, D1 — tally.ajshaham.workers.dev

- Framework-free, local-first training and nutrition PWA that works offline and syncs across devices, merging conflicting edits.

SHIPPED GAMES

- Programmer: **Keepie Uppies** (Unity, Android; team of 5), **RetrOsu** (crisp-game-lib; duo), **Wordle Cube** (Unity; solo)
- Programmer and producer: **Queen of the Hill** (JavaScript; team of 6), **Puffed Up** and **BarF** (Phaser 3; teams of 3), **Beast Within** (Ludum Dare 49)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Engines	Godot 4 (.NET), Unreal Engine 5 (C++, GAS), Unity, Phaser
Gameplay	Combat and ability systems, crowd control, bot AI, encounter design, deterministic simulation, netcode
Languages	C#, C++, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL, GDScript, Java
Web	React, Node.js, Hono, PostgreSQL, Cloudflare Workers, D1
Tools	Git, Diversion, YouTrack, Jira, xUnit, Vitest, GitHub Actions, Steamworks, Blender, Figma
Spoken	English (native), Spanish (proficient)

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz — B.S. Computer Science: Computer Game Design — Sep 2017 – Jun 2022

Coursework: Game Design I–III, Game Design Experience, Game Development Experience, Game Technologies, Game Systems